

Complaints Policy

A clear, fair route for raising concerns

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways is committed to providing a high-quality service to young people, families, schools, colleges and local authorities. We welcome feedback and take complaints seriously, using them to improve our practice.

2. Scope

This policy covers complaints about the standard of provision, communication, staff conduct, or any other aspect of L-Fit Pathways' service. Safeguarding concerns are not handled under this policy — they are dealt with immediately under our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy and, where relevant, referred to the LADO or children's social care without delay.

3. Stage 1 — Informal Resolution

Most concerns can be resolved quickly and informally. Complainants are encouraged to raise the issue directly with a Co-Director in the first instance, by phone or email. We aim to respond within 2 working days.

4. Stage 2 — Formal Complaint

If a concern is not resolved informally, or is serious in nature, it should be put in writing to adam.byrne@lfitpathways.com.

We aim to acknowledge formal complaints within 2 working days and provide a full written response within 10 working days. Where more time is needed, the complainant will be kept informed.

5. Stage 3 — Escalation

If the complainant remains dissatisfied following a formal response, the complaint will be reviewed jointly by both Co-Directors. Where the complaint originates from a commissioning school, college or local authority, it may also be escalated through that organisation's own complaints procedure and reviewed jointly.

Where the complaint relates to a placement commissioned by a school, college or local authority, the referring organisation's own provider complaints process may also be used in parallel with, or instead of, this procedure.

6. Anonymous & Third-Party Complaints

We will consider anonymous complaints where sufficient detail is provided, though our ability to investigate and respond may be limited.

7. Record Keeping

A log of all formal complaints, responses and outcomes is maintained by the Co-Directors and reviewed as part of our annual policy review, to identify any patterns and drive improvement.

8. Roles & Responsibilities

Adam Byrne and Craig Lloyd are jointly responsible for the handling of complaints and for ensuring this policy is followed consistently.

9. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027